

Contractor: Seed Innovations, LLC
Supply/Service: Edge Software Support V.2
[REDACTED]

**JUSTIFICATION REVIEW DOCUMENT
FOR JUSTIFICATION AND APPROVAL FOR OTHER THAN
FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION**

Supply/Service: Service

Authority: 41 U.S.C. 1901

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Technical:

[REDACTED]

Requirements:

[REDACTED]

Reviews: I have reviewed this justification and find it adequate to support other than full and open competition.

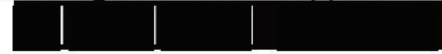
Program Manager:

[REDACTED]

Controlled by: Army Contracting Command – Rock Island CUI Category: <i>UNCLASSIFIED</i> Distribution Statement or LDC: Distribution D Authorized to the DoD and U.S. DoD contractors only. POC: Lathan.a.carter.civ@army.mil
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Justification and Approval

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**Department of Army
Justification and Approval for Other than
Full and Open Competition**

1. Contracting Activity: U.S. Army Contracting Command – Rock Island (ACC-RI)
Rock Island Arsenal, Rock Island, IL 61299-8000.

2. Description of Action

Network Enterprise Technology Command (NETCOM) requests a firm-fixed-price modification to contract W519TC-26-F-0027 with Seed Innovations, LLC to add new tasks to the Performance Work Statement (PWS). This action will incorporate emerging requirements that were originally planned for a future follow-on contract. ACC-RI projects the modification to be awarded in the current option period and will obligate fiscal year 2026 Operations and Maintenance, Army funds. An acquisition plan is not required because this procurement does not meet the threshold at Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement 207.103(d)(i)(B).

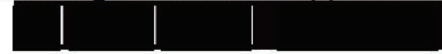
3. Description of Supplies/Services

This action adds new scope to provide development, integration, and support for new capabilities within the NETCOM Edge data science platform. The estimated value of this new work is [REDACTED]. The new tasks include:

- Task 7: Integrate AI Coding Assistant: Integrate an AI coding assistant powered by a Large Language Model (LLM) to provide real-time code suggestions, error detection, and documentation support within the NETCOM Edge development environments.
- Task 8: Enhance Vault Tool for Secure Group-Based Information Sharing: Extend the existing Vault tool to allow for the secure storage, sharing, and persistence of sensitive group/team information (e.g., API keys, credentials, and secrets) across both development and runtime environments.

CUI
Justification and Approval

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- Task 9: Integrate MLFlow Platform: Integrate the open-source MLFlow platform to provide a full lifecycle management solution, including experiment tracking, project management, standardized model packaging, and a central model registry for governance.
- Task 10: Integrate Kafka Streaming Data Support: Integrate Apache Kafka to enable the real-time ingestion, processing, and analysis of high-throughput streaming data from sources like U-SIEM, supporting advanced, real-time ML workflows.

The period of performance for these updated requirements will begin upon receipt of written notice of award and continue through the remaining five 1-month option periods of the contract through 18 August 2026.

4. Authority Cited

41 U.S.C. 1901, as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 13.501(a)(1)(ii), Sole source under the simplified procedures for certain commercial items.

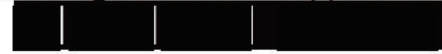
5. Reason for Authority Cited

As described in FAR 13.501(a)(1)(i), the contracting officer may conduct sole source acquisitions if the need is justified in writing. This requirement is for highly specialized services available only from the original source. An award to any other source would result in substantial duplication of cost that is not expected to be recovered through competition and unacceptable delays in fulfilling the agency's requirements.

Seed Innovations, Inc. is the original developer of the NETCOM Edge Data Science Development Platform. As a result, they possess unique and proprietary knowledge of the platform's architecture, internal workings, and codebase. The new tasks are not stand-alone requirements; they are complex integrations that must be woven into the existing platform.

- Unique Expertise: Integrating an AI assistant (Task 7), enhancing the security of the Vault tool (Task 8), and adding MLFlow (Task 9) and Kafka (Task 10) require

Contractor: Seed Innovations, LLC
Supply/Service: Edge Software Support V.2



an expert-level understanding of the existing environment to ensure seamless compatibility, security, and performance.

- **Unacceptable Delays:** A new contractor would require significant time (estimated at over 6 months) to reverse-engineer and learn the complexities of the NETCOM Edge platform before any new development could begin. This would create an unacceptable delay in delivering critical AI/ML and data streaming capabilities necessary for NETCOM's mission.

The original justification and approval for sole source for this contract highlighted these same issues, and the successful performance by Seed Innovations in the initial contract period has allowed the Government to accelerate these new tasks, which were originally planned for the follow-on contract. This acceleration allows NETCOM to further the EDGE platform development to a useful platform.

6. Efforts to Obtain Competition

ACC-RI shall publish the notice required by FAR 5.201. As this is a sole-source action to the original developer for highly specialized services, no effective competition is anticipated for this modification. The contract will continue to include FAR clause 52.244-5, Competition in Subcontracting, which requires the contractor to select subcontractors on a competitive basis to the maximum practicable extent. However, given the nature of the work, the likelihood of subcontracting is low as Seed Innovations has self-performed the work to date.

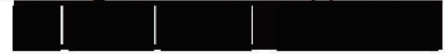
7. Actions to Increase Competition

This sole-source modification is a temporary measure to ensure the continued development of a critical capability while a larger, full-and-open competition is being conducted. NETCOM intends to transition the long-term requirement to a future contract vehicle being awarded by STRATCOM. This long-term strategy will maximize competition for the overall requirement.

8. Market Research

Market research was conducted in June 2025 for the original bridge contract and remains less than 12 months old, therefore it is still considered current. The research evaluated four capable vendors and concluded that only Seed Innovations could

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Supply/Service: Edge Software Support V.2



perform the required tasks without a substantial training and handover period, which would introduce an operational gap and severe risk to the mission. This conclusion is even more applicable to the new scope of work, which involves more complex and deep integrations into the existing platform. Any new vendor would face the same, if not greater, challenges and delays.

9. Interested Sources

A specific sources sought for the Army requirement was not posted as this work is add on to the original development. However the larger Air Force requirement received 19 responses during the initial market research phase.

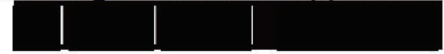
10. Other Facts

Procurement History:

- Contract Number: W519TC-23-F-0169
- Contractor: Seed Innovations, LLC
- Award Date: 18 May 2023
- Competitive Status: Small Business Set Aside
- Authority: FAR 13.501(a)(1)(i)

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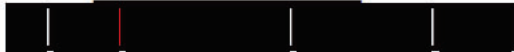
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11. Technical Certification

I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance which are included in the justification are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Date: 3/16/26



12. Requirements Certification

I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance which are included in the justification are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Date: 3/14/26



13. Fair and Reasonable Cost Determination

I hereby determine that the anticipated cost or price to the Government for this contract action will be fair and reasonable. A price analysis will be performed on the contractor's proposal to make a final determination. Other than certified cost or pricing data will not be required.

I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Date: 3/16/26

Shelly Robacker, Contracting Officer

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